

# **ALY 6060 Decision Support and Business Intelligence**

## **Module 2 – Stakeholder Involvement**

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## PART 1

1. **Question 1** - What are some strategies you can use to help maintain the stakeholder's commitment and involvement throughout a project's duration?

To maintain stakeholder commitment and involvement throughout a project, key strategies include: identifying and prioritizing stakeholders, developing a comprehensive communication plan, regularly providing updates, actively seeking feedback, involving them in decision-making processes, addressing concerns promptly, and consistently demonstrating transparency and trust-building actions throughout the project lifecycle.

- a. **Identify stakeholders early:** Before engaging stakeholders, it is essential to identify who they are to effectively support project goals. At the beginning of a project, conducting a thorough assessment of all potential stakeholders helps to clarify who holds influence or interest in the project's outcome. Stakeholders might include internal team members, executives, customers, suppliers, regulatory bodies, or community groups anyone impacted by or able to impact project success. Once identified, creating a project stakeholder register is the next step. This register is a comprehensive document that records key information about each stakeholder, such as their level of interest, influence, communication needs, and potential impact on the project. A well-maintained stakeholder register serves as a foundational tool for managing relationships and keeping engagement efforts targeted and effective throughout the project lifecycle.
- b. **Get stakeholders talking to one another:** Involving key stakeholders in the initial project meetings, particularly during the development of the project charter, is crucial for aligning expectations and addressing any potential conflicts early on. By bringing stakeholders into these initial discussions, you allow them to voice their concerns, share insights, and clarify their priorities, which helps to build a mutual understanding of the project's objectives and constraints. This proactive approach to conflict resolution not only fosters collaboration but also reduces the risk of misunderstandings that could hinder progress later. "I invite key stakeholders to my initial project meetings as we are developing the project charter. I want to surface and resolve conflicts as soon as possible." (10 ways to engage project stakeholders, Harry)

- c. **Seek to understand before being understood:** This approach emphasizes the importance of listening deeply and genuinely to others before sharing your own viewpoint. In any collaboration, people are more likely to engage openly when they feel that their perspectives are valued and truly considered. By making a conscious effort to understand stakeholders' needs, concerns, and motivations, you build trust and create a foundation of mutual respect. This not only strengthens relationships but also leads to more insightful and effective solutions, as people are more likely to contribute constructively when they feel heard.
  - d. **Really listen:** “Part of understanding is making time to sit face-to-face, when possible, and truly listen. Ask probing questions.” Understanding others deeply involves creating opportunities for face-to-face conversations whenever possible and dedicating time to truly listen. In these interactions, active listening goes beyond hearing words—it involves observing body language, tone, and expressions, which often reveal more than words alone. Asking thoughtful, probing questions further enriches the dialogue, showing genuine curiosity about the other person’s perspective and encouraging them to share insights they might otherwise withhold. This approach fosters a deeper connection, allowing you to uncover underlying needs and concerns, building trust, and facilitating a more collaborative environment for achieving shared goals. (10 ways to engage project stakeholders, Harry)
  - e. **Lead with integrity:** Building meaningful engagement hinges on establishing trust, which requires consistency and integrity in communication and actions. When you "say what you mean" and "mean what you say," you create clarity and reduce misunderstandings, helping others feel secure in your intentions. Following through—doing what you said you would do—is what solidifies that trust. Consistent reliability not only strengthens relationships but also sets a standard for accountability. Over time, this commitment to honest and dependable interaction fosters a culture where others feel valued and confident in the partnership, leading to more effective and engaged collaboration.
2. **Question 2** - What might be some negative consequences of low stakeholder involvement?
- a. Low stakeholder involvement can lead to significant negative consequences that impact the success and sustainability of a project. One of the primary risks is misalignment between project outcomes and stakeholder expectations. When stakeholders are not actively involved, their needs and expectations may not be fully understood or addressed, resulting in a final

product that does not meet their requirements. This misalignment can lead to dissatisfaction, lack of support, and even project failure, as the final deliverable may lack crucial elements that are important to those the project aims to serve.

- b. Another major consequence is the increased likelihood of conflict arising later in the project lifecycle. Stakeholders who are not engaged early on may feel left out or undervalued, which can lead to resistance, criticism, or attempts to modify project elements at inopportune times. This late-stage involvement often disrupts project timelines, creates additional work, and puts strain on resources as the team must adjust to accommodate new demands. Additionally, late-stage conflicts and change requests can demoralize the team, reducing productivity and commitment to the project goals.
- c. Low stakeholder involvement can also lead to decreased accountability and ownership among stakeholders. When stakeholders are not part of key discussions and decision-making processes, they may feel disconnected from the project's outcomes and objectives. This detachment can result in minimal support for the project, both during implementation and once it is completed. For example, in cases where stakeholders are expected to help roll out or maintain the project, lack of early involvement can lead to a reduced sense of responsibility and reluctance to provide the necessary support or resources. Consequently, the project may struggle with adoption or sustainability issues, limiting its long-term impact. "Having varied interest in the project and its outcome is usually a good thing, but a large number of different stakeholders can also pull the project team in too many directions." (How to manage common stakeholder issues and challenges)
- d. The absence of regular stakeholder input further increases the risk of missed opportunities for improvement. Stakeholders often provide unique insights that can refine and enhance a project, based on their expertise and understanding of the context. Without their perspectives, projects may overlook critical areas, such as compliance requirements, user-friendly design elements, or potential risks, which could otherwise be addressed proactively. This can lead to avoidable errors, inefficiencies, and potential legal or regulatory issues that compromise the project's viability.
- e. Finally, low stakeholder involvement weakens trust and relationships, which are essential for long-term collaboration. If stakeholders feel ignored or excluded, it can damage their relationship with the project team or organization, leading to a lack of willingness to

collaborate on future projects. This loss of trust can also impact the organization's reputation, making it more difficult to secure stakeholder buy in for future initiatives. Strong relationships built on trust and mutual respect are vital for successful project outcomes and organizational growth, as they encourage open communication, innovation, and support.

- f. To avoid the consequences, it is crucial to engage stakeholders early and maintain consistent, open communication throughout the project. This active involvement fosters alignment, minimizes resistance, enhances accountability, and builds a foundation of trust that is essential for project success and future collaboration.

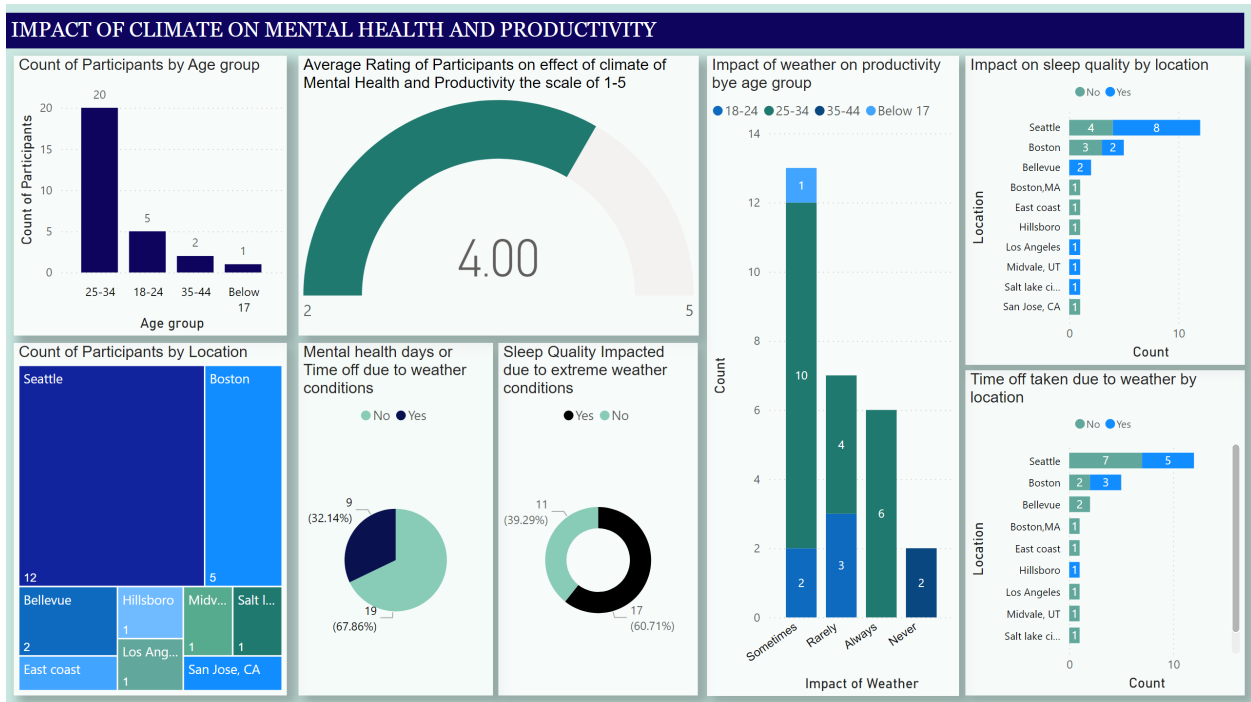
**3. Question 3** - How can these strategies also help develop a data analytics culture?

Engaging stakeholders, fostering trust, and prioritizing open communication are strategies that can significantly support the development of a strong data analytics culture within an organization. A data analytics culture is built on the widespread adoption of data-driven decision-making practices, and these strategies lay the groundwork for integrating analytics into the organization's core operations and mindset.

- a. **Alignment and Buy-In:** Actively involving stakeholders in the early stages of analytics projects ensures that the insights and outcomes are aligned with their needs, challenges, and objectives. When stakeholders see that their input shapes analytics initiatives, they are more likely to value data as a tool for achieving their goals. This buy-in is crucial, as it helps shift perspectives from viewing data analytics as merely a technical or peripheral function to recognizing it as essential for solving business problems and making informed decisions.
- b. **Building Trust in Data:** A data analytics culture thrives on trust in data as a reliable foundation for decision-making. By following through on commitments, addressing concerns openly, and delivering results consistently, data teams can build this trust with stakeholders. Trust also grows when stakeholders feel that their questions and doubts about data are welcomed and addressed, creating a sense of security and openness that encourages them to rely on data. Additionally, transparent and clear data communication practices—such as data literacy programs, accessible visualizations, and regular updates—reinforce stakeholders' confidence in analytics, making them more comfortable incorporating data into their daily work.

- c. Collaboration and Cross-Functional Engagement:** The most important thing to consider when engaging stakeholders is that they are only human. They may not act in the most rational way 100% of the time, and may react impulsively from time to time. When data analytics teams engage stakeholders across various departments, they help foster a collaborative approach to analytics. This approach involves understanding the unique needs of each department, which encourages cross-functional alignment and a shared commitment to data-driven outcomes. (Engaging Stakeholder – Principles of Stakeholder Management, Verto)
- d. Encouraging Accountability and Ownership:** Actively involving stakeholders in analytics projects promotes a sense of accountability and ownership of data-driven decisions. When stakeholders see their contributions reflected in analytics initiatives, they are more inclined to take responsibility for using data insights and ensuring data quality. This accountability nurtures a culture where individuals take initiative to apply data thoughtfully and are motivated to learn more about analytics, further embedding data use within the organization’s daily practices. Over time, this approach fosters a sense of ownership over data outcomes, as stakeholders view themselves as partners in analytics rather than passive recipients of insights.

## PART 2



This dashboard presents an analysis of the "Impact of Climate on Mental Health and Productivity" across different demographic and geographic segments.

**a. Count of Participants by Age Group:**

- The age group 25-34 has the largest number of participants (20), followed by 18-24 (5). Smaller counts are observed for older and younger groups, indicating a sample skewed towards young adults.

**b. Average Rating on Climate Impact:**

- The average self-reported rating on the impact of climate on mental health and productivity is 4.00 on a scale of 1 to 5. This high rating suggests that participants perceive a substantial effect of climate on their mental well-being and productivity.

**c. Impact of Weather on Productivity by Age Group:**

- Participants were asked how often weather impacts their productivity. Most responses fall under "Sometimes," with a notable difference across age groups: 25-34 is the largest group affected.

**d. Count of Participants by Location:**

- Seattle has the highest number of participants (12), followed by Boston (5). Other locations have significantly fewer respondents, showing that most data is concentrated in specific regions.

**e. Mental Health Days Due to Weather:**

- The pie chart indicates that 32.14% of participants reported taking mental health days due to weather conditions, while 67.86% did not, highlighting that while some are affected, it may not be a universal issue.

**f. Sleep Quality Impacted by Extreme Weather:**

- 60.71% of participants stated their sleep quality was affected by extreme weather, showing that climate can have a physical impact on rest and recovery for a majority of respondents.

**g. Impact on Sleep Quality by Location:**

- Seattle and Boston show notable numbers of participants affected by weather-related sleep issues, with more participants in Seattle reporting issues compared to other locations.

**h. Time Off Taken Due to Weather by Location:**

- In Seattle, 5 participants took time off due to weather, while 7 did not. This trend varies by location, with a few instances in other regions.
- This dashboard provides a comprehensive overview of how climate and extreme weather influence mental health, productivity, and sleep quality, highlighting demographic differences and location-based impacts.

## References

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